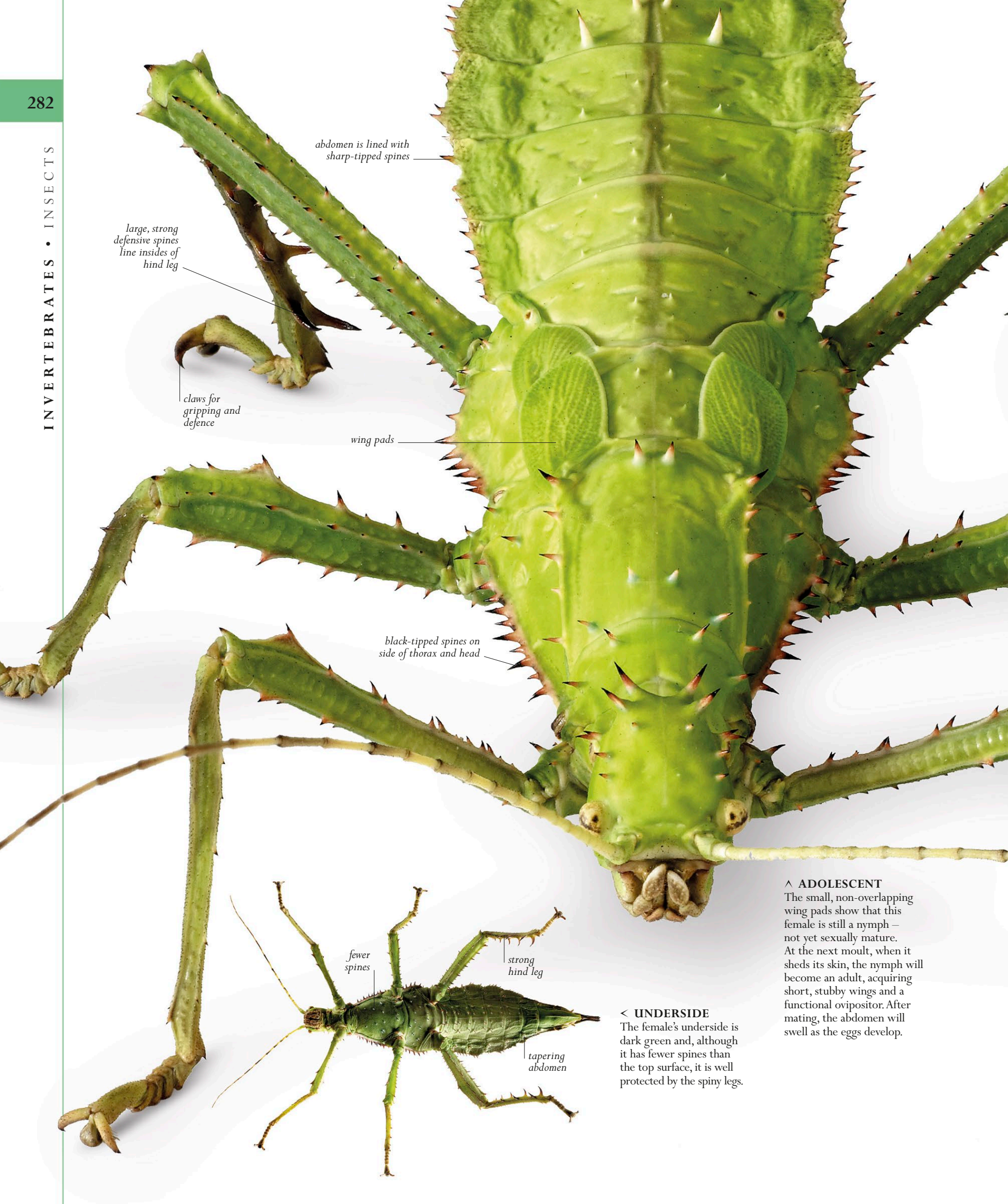




abdomen is lined with sharp-tipped spines

large, strong defensive spines line insides of hind leg

claws for gripping and defence

wing pads

black-tipped spines on side of thorax and head

fewer spines

strong hind leg

tapering abdomen

^ ADOLESCENT

The small, non-overlapping wing pads show that this female is still a nymph — not yet sexually mature. At the next moult, when it sheds its skin, the nymph will become an adult, acquiring short, stubby wings and a functional ovipositor. After mating, the abdomen will swell as the eggs develop.

< UNDERSIDE

The female's underside is dark green and, although it has fewer spines than the top surface, it is well protected by the spiny legs.